to a Dockerized irb prompt with `docker run -it ruby irb`. Running external Ruby files in the Docker container is doable as well, but requires a little more Docker knowledge.

## Creating Ruby Programs

The most common way to write Ruby programs is to put the Ruby code in one or more text files. You'll use a text editor or Integrated Development Environment (IDE) to create and maintain these files—there are many popular editors, including Visual Studio Code, vim, Sublime Text, and RubyMine that feature Ruby support. You'll then run the files either from within the editor or from the command line. Both techniques are useful, you might run from within the editor for single-file programs and from the command line for more complex ones.

Let's create a simple Ruby program and run it. Open a terminal window and create an empty directory somewhere, perhaps you could call it `pickaxe`.

Then, using your editor of choice, create the file `myprog.rb`, containing the following text.

pickaxe/myprog.rb

```
puts "Hello, Ruby Programmer"
puts "It is now #{Time.now}"
```

Note that the second string contains the text `Time.now` between curly braces, not parentheses.

You can run a Ruby program from a file as you would any other shell script or program in another scripting language like Python. Simply run the Ruby interpreter, giving it the script name as an argument:

```
$ ruby myprog.rb
Hello, Ruby Programmer
It is now 2022-12-25 12:29:56 -0600
```

On Unix systems, you can use the "shebang" notation as the first line of the program file. If your system supports it, you can avoid hard-coding the path to Ruby in the "shebang" line by using `#!/usr/bin/env ruby`, which will search your path for `ruby` and then execute it.

```
#!/usr/bin/env ruby
puts "Hello, Ruby Programmer"
puts "It is now #{Time.now}"
```

If you make this source file executable (using, for instance, `chmod +x myprog.rb`), Unix lets you run the file as a program:

```
$ ./myprog.rb
Hello, Ruby Programmer
It is now 2022-12-25 12:29:56 -0600
```

You can do something similar under Microsoft Windows using file associations, and you can run Ruby GUI applications by double-clicking their names in Windows Explorer.